



20 |

STATE SUPPORT Launched in 2020, the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana provides 5 kg of free foodgrain per person per month. It has had a huge impact with an estimated 813.5 million beneficiaries

ECONOMY

FOOD BILL

PM Modi's announcement extending the PMGKAY by five years may not impact the fiscal deficit target immediately, but higher outlays on welfare schemes ahead of the 2024 polls may prove tricky

BY SURABHI

► **AT AN ELECTION** rally in Chhattisgarh's Durg, Prime Minister Narendra Modi made a surprise announcement that the government will extend the scheme to provide free foodgrain for five more years until December 2028. Of course, it wasn't expected to come to an abrupt end.

Launched at the height of the Covid-19 pandemic in 2020, the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY) provides 5 kg of free foodgrain per person per month and was set to be discontinued by December-end, 2023. The scheme has had a huge impact with an estimated 813.5

PHOTO BY GETTY IMAGES